Privacy Policy

Updated: 18 October 2026. Document package: 2026-10-18.1. This notice explains the processing of personal data on wwwhypda, a noncommercial scientific data sharing service. Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (GDPR) and applicable Italian data protection law apply to this processing.

1. Who is responsible

The data controller is Georgii Gvozdik, Milan, Italy. For questions about privacy, account deletion, uploaded personal information or any of the rights below, email support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it.

Support enquiries, complaints and privacy requests are currently handled by Georgii Gvozdik through the contact address above. Ordinary enquiries are answered without undue delay, normally within one month; if resolving an issue takes longer, the controller explains the status and next steps. Requests to exercise data protection rights follow the statutory response periods in section 7. Correspondence is kept only as needed to handle the request and is deleted under the closure-based schedule in section 6, subject to the limited legal exceptions described there.

2. What we collect

- Account information: email, username, a password hash, activation status, account identifier and permissions. New registrations also have a server-generated registration time and a record of whether registration has ever been completed. We record the accepted User Agreement version and a server-generated acceptance time for registration and any later explicit acceptance of an updated document package. Earlier known versions and dates are preserved in the acceptance history; missing historical facts are not invented. Passwords are submitted for authentication but stored as hashes, rather than readable passwords.
- Registration and password reset codes, their associated email, purpose and creation time.
- Dataset submissions: measurements, samples, site and source information, submission time, submitter identifier and name, review status and comments. The dedicated authors field is temporarily disabled in the form, and the submission endpoint rejects a nonempty authors value. Do not enter other people's names in other fields. Free-text fields can still contain personal information you provide; disabling the authors field does not make every submission anonymous.
- Technical information: requests, IP addresses and browser information in service logs, and technical and interaction signals processed by Google reCAPTCHA to detect abuse.
- Support and privacy correspondence: sender and recipient addresses, message content and any attachments you provide, message dates, replies, handling status and the recorded closure date used for mailbox cleanup. Provide only information needed to handle your request.
- Browser preferences and form drafts described in our Cookie Policy.

3. Why we use it and the legal basis

- Creating and operating your account, authenticating requests, handling submissions and sending requested confirmation and password reset messages and necessary notices about account security or material changes affecting the service: performance of the service agreement, Article 6(1)(b) GDPR.
- Preventing spam, automated abuse and account misuse, reviewing submissions, investigating faults and keeping evidence of the agreed terms while operating accounts: legitimate interests in providing a safe, reliable service and documenting its conditions, Article 6(1)(f). You may object on grounds relating to your situation.
- Handling ordinary account-support requests: performance of the service agreement, Article 6(1)(b), where the request concerns that agreement. Handling other ordinary enquiries: legitimate interests in answering enquiries and resolving service issues, Article 6(1)(f).

- Responding to privacy requests and complying with applicable legal duties: Article 6(1)(c), where such a duty applies.

The registration or updated-terms checkbox acknowledges this notice and the Cookie Policy and accepts the User Agreement. It is not blanket consent to unrelated processing. Registering does not subscribe you to a newsletter. Optional update or promotional mailings require a separate, voluntary choice and an easy way to unsubscribe before they are introduced.

Email, username and password are required for an account. Without them we cannot register or authenticate you. You may read public information without an account, although selected public data requests also use abuse protection. You do not have to submit a dataset. Registration is restricted to adults aged 18 or over. We collect a confirmation of adulthood, rather than your date of birth or identity document. If an account belonging to a minor is identified, contact the controller so that it can be reviewed.

4. Access to accounts and scientific submissions

Account details, form entries and correspondence come from you. Although author entry is temporarily disabled for new submissions, scientific references in the separate catalogue or personal information entered in other fields may identify other people, such as authors of cited scientific work. We receive that information from the submitting user and the sources identified in the submission, which may be publicly accessible scientific publications. The fact that a name appears in a publication does not remove that person's data protection rights.

Where a submission contains limited author information needed to identify and attribute a scientific source, we rely on legitimate interests in accurate attribution and review of scientific submissions, Article 6(1)(f), subject to necessity and the rights and interests of the person concerned. The account agreement with the submitter does not by itself provide a contractual basis for processing another person's data. Unnecessary or unlawful personal information must be corrected or removed. You may object by contacting the controller and identifying the relevant record.

For personal information obtained from another person or source, the controller provides the information required by Article 14 GDPR within the applicable time limits, unless a specific legal exemption applies and is documented. Making this notice available does not by itself replace individual information where it is required; a publicly available source alone is not an automatic exemption.

Uploaded scientific submissions, including measurements, source information and comments, are currently accessible to the submitting account and authorised site administrators, rather than published for visitors. This restriction applies to uploaded submissions; the separate scientific catalogue remains publicly accessible. Administrators can access account email addresses and usernames where needed to operate the service and review submissions. Passwords are stored as hashes, not displayed as readable passwords. Any future publication of uploaded material containing personal information will require a separate assessment of its legal basis and appropriate information before that publication begins.

Do not upload passwords, private contact details, confidential material or sensitive personal data. Author entry is temporarily disabled for new submissions; do not use other fields to enter other people's names. Include only information necessary for the submission that you are entitled to share. Restricted administrator access does not remove the need for lawful processing or the rights of the people named in a submission. Contact the controller about personal information requiring correction or removal, including information uploaded by another person.

5. Providers and transfers

Hosting is provided by OVH SRL (OVHcloud), acting as a processor of hosted personal data under its Data Processing Agreement (Article 28 GDPR); the contractual DPA reviewed for this notice is dated 17 October 2025. The application server is located in Strasbourg, France, within the European Union. OVHcloud manages the underlying infrastructure; the controller administers the application and its personal data. See OVHcloud's Data Processing Agreement and service terms.

OVHcloud may use authorised subprocessors for service operation, security and maintenance. Under the DPA, OVHcloud and authorised subprocessors may access or process hosted data remotely where necessary to provide those services; this is separate from the location where the VPS stores the data. Its subprocessor list includes group companies in the European Union, Canada and the United Kingdom for ordinary services. Inclusion in this list does not mean that every listed company receives this site's data. Server location alone does not establish that all processing takes place in France. Where an international transfer requires safeguards, the DPA provides for applicable standard contractual clauses; contact the controller for information about the safeguards relevant to your data and how to obtain a copy.

Automated daily VPS backups are enabled and may contain copies of the site's database and account records. For the backup service currently used by this site, OVHcloud support confirmed that backups are stored in the same datacentre as the VPS and that a new daily backup replaces the previous one, with a stated retention period of 24 hours. This is service-specific information supplied by OVHcloud, rather than a statement that every OVHcloud service or every copy of this site's data has the same retention period.

OVHcloud Zimbra Starter provides the service mailbox support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it and SMTP delivery of requested registration confirmation, resend and password reset messages. The application sends the recipient address, service sender, subject and a short verification-code message; it does not include your password, username or scientific dataset. OVHcloud also processes technical delivery information. Support and privacy requests use the same mailbox. These requested account messages do not subscribe you to promotional mailings.

The Zimbra service is covered by the applicable OVHcloud service terms and Data Processing Agreement. The controller administers the mailbox and handles requests; OVHcloud operates the email infrastructure. The VPS location and its 24-hour daily backup arrangement do not establish the location or retention of every email copy. Provider queues, security records and technical backups follow the applicable email terms; this notice does not promise immediate erasure of those copies.

Earlier correspondence may remain in the former consumer Gmail mailbox, wwhypda@gmail.com, during individual migration and erasure review. It is not the selected SMTP service for new production messages. Consumer Gmail is governed by Google's consumer terms and privacy policy, rather than an OVHcloud or reCAPTCHA processing agreement. The controller reviews legacy correspondence under the same necessity and closure-based retention policy below; changing the sending configuration does not erase old Gmail correspondence.

Google services may involve processing outside the European Economic Area. Their actual role and safeguards depend on the applicable service terms and the controller's arrangements. For reCAPTCHA, Google's current terms provide for processing of customer data as a processor; see the data processing information and Cloud Data Processing Addendum. Contact the controller for information about applicable transfer safeguards and how to obtain a copy. Uploaded scientific submissions are not currently made public; access by a hosting or email provider is separate from public publication.

For these security checks, the controller relies on legitimate interests in protecting accounts and preventing misuse, Article 6(1)(f) GDPR. A failed automated check can prevent the requested authentication action; it does not decide employment, credit or other eligibility. You can retry and contact support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it without CAPTCHA or an account to request human review of a suspected false block or to exercise your rights. Objections are considered under the rules in section 7; an objection does not automatically disable necessary security checks. Whether technical storage is exempt from cookie consent depends separately on the strictly necessary scope of the deployed service, not just this legal basis or Google's description of a cookie.

6. Retention and deletion

Confirmed account records, including the history of recorded User Agreement versions and acceptance times, are retained while the account is maintained and are removed with the account under the deletion process below. You can delete your account using the Delete account action in your account area or request erasure by email. Deactivating an account or logging out does not erase its database record.

Unconfirmed registrations

Unfinished registrations with a known original registration time and a record that registration has never been completed are automatically deleted after one calendar month in UTC. Deletion removes the account, including its email, username, password hash, permissions and any recorded agreement acceptance, all its verification codes and any submissions linked to it. Requesting another code or registering again before deletion does not extend the original period. Previously confirmed accounts are not deleted by this schedule, including accounts subsequently disabled by an administrator. Older records without reliable registration dates or completion history are excluded from automatic account deletion and require individual review by the controller; their dates are not guessed. Superuser accounts are also excluded as a safety measure and require operator review. Expiry or deletion of a verification code alone does not delete the account.

Calendar periods preserve the UTC time of day; if the original day does not exist in the target month, the last day of that month is used. The cleanup worker runs immediately when started and then every hour. Scheduled deletion occurs on the first successful pass after the period is reached, normally within the next hour plus processing time. A database failure or stopped worker can delay physical deletion. The controller monitors successful passes, resolves failures and checks overdue or excluded records. This process does not erase drafts on other devices, delivered emails, the separate public catalogue or provider backup copies; those have the separate handling described below.

Verification codes

Registration confirmation and password reset codes are valid for 2 minutes from creation. At that point they are rejected even if background deletion is delayed. Successfully used codes are deleted immediately; expired records are checked for deletion every minute. During normal operation this means deletion within approximately 3 minutes of creation. If cleanup is interrupted by a technical fault, expired codes remain unusable and are deleted after cleanup resumes. These short deadlines apply to verification code records, rather than all account or scientific data.

Account and uploaded scientific data

A Delete account action is available for both ordinary and administrator accounts. It requires your current password and abuse protection. It removes the account record, including its email address and username, its registration and password reset codes, and submission records directly linked to your account, and revokes access through existing sessions. Account deletion does not by itself guarantee the removal of author names or other personal information entered into separate scientific records or another person's submission. Review-name labels that cannot be attributed to a specific account because names are shared require separate review.

You can also delete an individual submission directly from your account's submission list using its delete action, without deleting your account. The server checks ownership and removes that submission record and its stored form data. This action does not by itself remove information copied into separate scientific records or another person's submission; request review of such information using the contact below. Existing backup copies have the separate retention described in this notice.

You can request deletion of your uploaded scientific data or correction or erasure of personal information in a submission by emailing support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it, identifying the relevant records. You do not have to delete your account to make this request, and a person named in a submission does not need an account to exercise their rights. The controller handles these requests and any required earlier removal manually, without undue delay and within one month of receiving the request, subject to any applicable legal exception. If a request cannot be fulfilled, the controller explains the reason and available complaint rights. Any legally permitted extension for a complex request is communicated within the first month, as described below.

Private uploaded scientific submissions are automatically deleted after six calendar months in UTC from their original submission time, including their measurements, samples, site and source information, submitter name, review status, editor label and comments. Reading, editing or reviewing a submission, and changing its status to New, In editing or Completed, do not restart this period. This scheduled submission deletion does not delete the account or its verification codes. Records without a

reliable submission time require individual operator review. Earlier deletion through your account or a lawful request remains available. The separate public scientific catalogue is outside this automatic cleanup. The browser performing account deletion clears that account's local drafts and account state while preserving appearance preferences; the server cannot erase browser storage on another device. Browser draft storage has no automatic expiry and can also be cleared as described in the Cookie Policy.

Backups, logs and service correspondence

Deleting an account or scientific record from the application database does not immediately modify an existing VPS backup. According to OVHcloud's confirmation for the current daily backup service, that backup is retained for 24 hours and replaced by the next daily copy. This replacement removes the older backup copy; data still present in the live database will also be present in the new backup. This description assumes the daily backup service continues to operate as configured and does not cover separately retained exports, snapshots, logs or email. If backup replacement is interrupted, the controller must address any retained copy with the provider. Before restored data are returned to use, earlier erasure requests and scheduled deletions must be reapplied so that deleted accounts or personal information are not reinstated.

Expiry or deletion of a verification code does not recall a delivered email. No Sent copy of the code message was observed in the current OVH SMTP acceptance check; the application does not create an additional mailbox copy. This does not establish that the provider has no transient delivery or technical records. Where an accessible service-mailbox copy exists, the retention policy is one calendar month, counted conservatively from its reliable mailbox date and first recorded observation, with individual review of uncertain copies. Automated mailbox erasure is not currently enabled; the controller must handle due copies manually. Copies in the recipient's mailbox are under the recipient's control.

Site application and web-server logs are retained for no longer than 30 days during normal operation and are removed through automated daily rotation. Rotation is configured with a shorter archive limit to leave a margin within this maximum period. If the scheduled cleanup is interrupted by a technical fault, the controller must resolve the fault and delete overdue logs. Deleted logs may remain in an existing VPS backup until that backup is replaced under the separate backup retention described above.

Support and privacy correspondence received at support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it, including replies, is retained while the request is being handled. Unresolved requests are not deleted solely because they are old. Ordinary completed support enquiries are manually erased no later than six calendar months after recorded closure, where retaining that context is necessary to handle a related follow-up or verify the answer given. This is a maximum ordinary retention period, not a requirement to keep every message for six months; unnecessary information and valid requests for earlier erasure are reviewed and handled sooner. Closure is recorded only after the controller has completed the enquiry and all accessible copies of its chain, including outgoing replies, are together in the manually designated Closed folder. Its recorded retention date starts at the first complete observation of that closed chain. A new related message or reopening cancels that date; a subsequent explicit closure starts a new period. Unclear links, drafts or other uncertainty require operator review and are not permission for indefinite retention.

The prepared daily mailbox task is scheduled for 01:30 Europe/Rome when enabled. For eligible service-message copies, its first successful pass strictly after the one-calendar-month threshold normally adds at most one further day; automated mailbox erasure is not currently enabled. Support correspondence follows the separate six-calendar-month manual schedule above, with a recorded due date and reminders; it is not automatically erased by that task. The controller must review due or excluded records, resolve failures and carry out appropriate erasure manually. Correspondence about data-protection rights and any sensitive information require a separate necessity review: only the minimum evidence needed to demonstrate handling is retained, rather than automatically keeping every complete message for six months. Only information necessary for a specific legal obligation or substantiated legal claim may be kept longer to the extent permitted by law. Provider technical copies and correspondents' own mailboxes have separate handling.

7. Your rights

Subject to the GDPR's conditions, you can request access and a copy, correction, erasure, restriction, and portability of data processed by automated means on the basis of consent or contract. You may object to processing based on legitimate interests. Where processing relies on consent, you can withdraw it without affecting earlier lawful processing. We may ask for proportionate information to verify your identity; do not send identity documents unless needed and requested.

Send requests to support@wwhypdatestdeployversion.it. Requests are normally answered within one month; an extension of up to two further months is possible for complex or numerous requests, with notice and reasons within the first month. Requests are normally free of charge, subject to the GDPR's exceptions.

You may complain to the Italian Garante per la protezione dei dati personali or another competent supervisory authority, including in your place of habitual residence or work. You do not have to contact us first.

8. Automated checks and security

Google reCAPTCHA v3 protects explicit scientific searches, sign-in, registration, confirmation-code and password-recovery attempts against automated high-volume data queries, credential guessing, false registrations and misuse of the email-code functions. It is loaded from www.recaptcha.net only after you attempt one of these actions; merely opening a page does not request a reCAPTCHA token. Initial scientific-data lookups, session checks, authenticated submission and account deletion use the site's other access and abuse controls instead. Following activation of reCAPTCHA, Google may process IP address, browser and device information, technical and interaction signals and security cookies while the action-specific reCAPTCHA context remains present. The application loads it in a separate same-origin frame after an explicit action and removes that frame when leaving the eligible route; the main page shell remains in place. This does not erase existing Google cookies. The site does not send your email, password or dataset payload through its server verification request, which sends the verification token and secret only. This does not mean that the browser script receives no page context or other technical signals.

9. Changes

The current document package and downloadable PDFs are available without an account. When its version changes, account access requires explicit acceptance of the updated User Agreement and acknowledgement of the policies; refusal does not automatically delete the account or prevent privacy requests. This is not general consent to new purposes. Material changes will be explained in an updated notice before the new processing begins; where a new use requires consent, consent will be requested separately. See also our Cookie Policy and User Agreement.